

1 The Fundamental Laws and Processes of Algebra

Exercises I

1. Point out in what sense the usual arrangement of the multiplication of 365 by 492 is an instance of the law of distribution.

The usual arrangement is

$$\begin{array}{r}
 365 \\
 \times 492 \\
 \hline
 730 \quad \leftarrow 365 \times 2 \\
 3285 \quad \leftarrow 365 \times 90 \\
 + 1460 \quad \leftarrow 365 \times 400 \\
 \hline
 179580
 \end{array}$$

Decimal notation already gives the multiplier as a sum, one term per digit: $492 = 400 + 90 + 2$. The arrangement therefore computes

$$365 \times 492 = 365 \times (2 + 90 + 400) = 365 \times 2 + 365 \times 90 + 365 \times 400.$$

This is the *law of distribution*, $a(b + c + d) = ab + ac + ad$, with $a = 365$, $b = 2$, $c = 90$, $d = 400$.

The shifting of the second and third rows comes from writing $365 \times 90 = (365 \times 9) \times 10$, an instance of association, together with the decimal place-shift.

2. I have a multiplying machine, but the most it can do at one time is to multiply a number of 10 digits by another number of 10 digits. Explain how I can use my machine to multiply 13693456783231 by 46381239245932.

First we cut the multiplier and multiplicand into digits we can enter into the machine. For decimal notation, we can do this preparation by splitting them into a sum of two

units.

$$13693456783231 = 1369345 \times 10^7 + 6783231$$

$$46381239245932 = 4638123 \times 10^7 + 9245932$$

Now each number is of the form $x_2 \times 10^7 + x_1$, with the two variables consisting of 7 digits each.

Now, giving the multiplicand and multiplier the assignments $a = 1369345$, $b = 6783231$, $c = 4638123$ and $d = 9245932$ and by application of the *law of distribution*

$$\begin{aligned} & 13693456783231 \times 46381239245932 \\ &= (a \times 10^7 + b) \times (c \times 10^7 + d) \\ &= a \times 10^7 \times c \times 10^7 + ad \times 10^7 + bc \times 10^7 + bd \\ &= ac \times 10^{14} + (ad + bc) \times 10^7 + bd \end{aligned}$$

Now we can use our multiplying machine to perform the four multiplications, namely ac , ad , bc and bd . The remaining operations, multiplications by a power of 10 and simple addition, can be done by hand.

3. To divide 5004 by 12 is the same as to divide 5004 by 3, and then divide the quotient thus obtained by 4. Of what law of algebra is this an instance?

This is an instance of the *law of association*. Since $12 = 3 \times 4$, we have the statement $5004 \div (3 \times 4) = 5004 \div 3 \div 4$. Notice the removal of the bracket, and since $\div$ precedes the bracket, every sign within has been reversed.

4. If the remainder on dividing N by a be R , and the quotient P , and if we divide P by b and find a remainder S , show that the remainder on dividing N by ab will be $aS + R$. Illustrate with $5015 \div 12$.

5. Show how to multiply two numbers of 10 digits each so as to obtain merely the number of digits in the product, and the first three digits on the left of the product. Illustrate by finding the number of digits, and the first three left-hand digits in the following:

a) $3659893456789325678 \times 342973489379265$;

b) 2^{64} .

6. Express in the simplest form—

$$-(-(-(-(\dots (-1) \dots)))),$$

a) where there are $2n$ brackets;

b) where there are $2n + 1$ brackets; n being any whole number whatever.

7. Simplify and condense as much as possible—

$$2a - \{3a - [a - (b - a)]\}.$$

8. Simplify—

a) $3\{4 - 5[6 - 7(8 - 9 \cdot \overline{10 - 11})]\};$

b) $\frac{1}{3}\{\frac{1}{4} - \frac{1}{5}[\frac{1}{6} - \frac{1}{7}(\frac{1}{8} - \frac{1}{9} \cdot \overline{\frac{1}{10} - \frac{1}{11}})]\}.$

9. Simplify—

$$1 - (2 - (3 - (4 - \dots (9 - (10 - 11)) \dots))).$$

10. Distribute the following products:

a) $(a + b) \times (a + b);$

b) $(a - b) \times (a + b);$

c) $(3a - 6b) \times (3a + 6b);$

d) $(\frac{1}{3}a - \frac{1}{6}b) \times (\frac{1}{3}a + \frac{1}{6}b).$

11. Simplify, by expanding and condensing as much as possible—

$$\begin{aligned} & \{(m + 1)a + (n + 1)b\}\{(m - 1)a + (n - 1)b\} \\ & + \{(m + 1)a - (n + 1)b\}\{(m - 1)a - (n - 1)b\}. \end{aligned}$$

12. Simplify—

$$\left(x + \frac{1}{x}\right)\left(y + \frac{1}{y}\right) + \left(x - \frac{1}{x}\right)\left(y - \frac{1}{y}\right).$$

13. Simplify—

$$\left(x + \frac{1}{x}\right)\left(y + \frac{1}{y}\right)\left(z + \frac{1}{z}\right) - \left(x - \frac{1}{x}\right)\left(y - \frac{1}{y}\right)\left(z - \frac{1}{z}\right).$$

14. Expand and condense as much as possible—

$$(\frac{1}{2}x + \frac{1}{4}y + \frac{1}{8}z)(\frac{1}{2}x - \frac{1}{4}y + \frac{1}{8}z).$$